



BRAND IDENTITY SYSTEM
VERSION 1.0 · 2026

first artifact

Brand identity system for a
selective club of founders and
builders.

CREATIVE NORTH STAR

The Living Signal

MEMBERSHIP

Founders and builders only

contents

This book owns who we are, how we sound, and which assets make us recognizable.
Product truth lives in PRODUCT.md. Production tokens live in DESIGN.md.

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BELIEF

obsession beats talent everytime

and the proof is the artifact.

ARCHITECTURE

monolithic branded house

One master brand. Events, formats, and future products are descriptors under First Artifact — never independent sibling brands.

FIRST ARTIFACT

BRAND IDENTITY · 02

Who We are

First Artifact is a selective club **for founders and builders only**. It concentrates people whose defining trait is obsession expressed through action: they build, ship, learn, and persist — then meet peers at the same density.

First Artifact is the only selective club for founders and builders that admits on shipped proof and sustained obsession — not talent theater, credentials, or talk.

TRUELINE (INTERNAL) Obsession beats talent because obsessed people keep acting. The artifact is the proof. Membership is founders and builders only.	POSITIONING Not a broad networking group. Not a generic tech community. Distinction is a deliberately high, evidence-based acceptance bar. Exclusivity is functional — it protects density and creates a credible signal.
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category enemy

Rooms that reward pitch, potential, and proximity over work. Soft networks that dilute density. Open “anyone in tech” clubs that blur builders with spectators.

IDEAL	HOW IT SHOWS UP
Differentiation	Evidence bar + Living Signal system; fails Swap Test if a competitor logo still “fits”
Authenticity	Honest placeholders, explicit unknowns, no fabricated proof
Coherence	Red / white / near-black fields, lowercase declarations, flat surfaces
Flexibility	Same mark and palette across header, manifesto, social, future formats
Commitment	Density over volume; the bar does not loosen for growth vanity

founders and builders only

No other member segments. Both must be proven people in technology with unusual agency — already shipped something meaningful, still moving without manufactured momentum.

FOUNDER

founder

Building or running a venture. The work is the company. Obsessed with a problem worth founding around.

BUILDER

builder

Shipping product, systems, or tools with real traction or public weight. The work is the artifact.

NOT MEMBERS	WHY
Investors (as primary identity)	Dealflow is not the membership purpose
Recruiters	Extraction posture dilutes the room
Pure operators / advisors without a build practice	No shipped proof at the center
Students without shipped work	Potential is not evidence
Spectators / “anyone in tech”	Blurs builders with audience

ADMISSION LANGUAGE

High agency — you notice what needs doing and move it.

Obsession — the personal story that keeps you returning to the same problem.

Traction — something real is already moving: shipped product, users, revenue, or public weight.

Adjacent roles may appear at carefully managed future touchpoints. They do not redefine who the club is for.

how we sound

Fun, playful, experimental, and strong — never corporate-prestige theater and never soft motivational fluff. A transmission from people already in motion.

TRAIT	MEANS	DOES NOT MEAN
Direct	Short sentences; name the standard	Rudeness or gatekeeping theater
Selective	Clear bar, scarce access	Elitism for its own sake
Energetic	Motion, scale, signal red	Glow, hype copy, emoji
Honest	State intended vs. proven	Fake metrics or invented members
Irreverent	Lowercase GoCake declarations	Sloppy grammar as personality

voice principles

- **Evidence over potential** — prefer shipped, artifact, traction.
- **Open declarations** — titles lowercase, no trailing full stop.
- **Name the unknown** — intended formats, unannounced dates, unavailable submission.
- **Agency language** — members initiate; the brand does not manufacture momentum.
- **One job per line** — headlines carry one idea.

USE

founders

builders

obsessed

ship

artifact

agency

traction

density

signal

AVOID

anyone in tech

networking mixer

thought leadership

passion

community for everyone

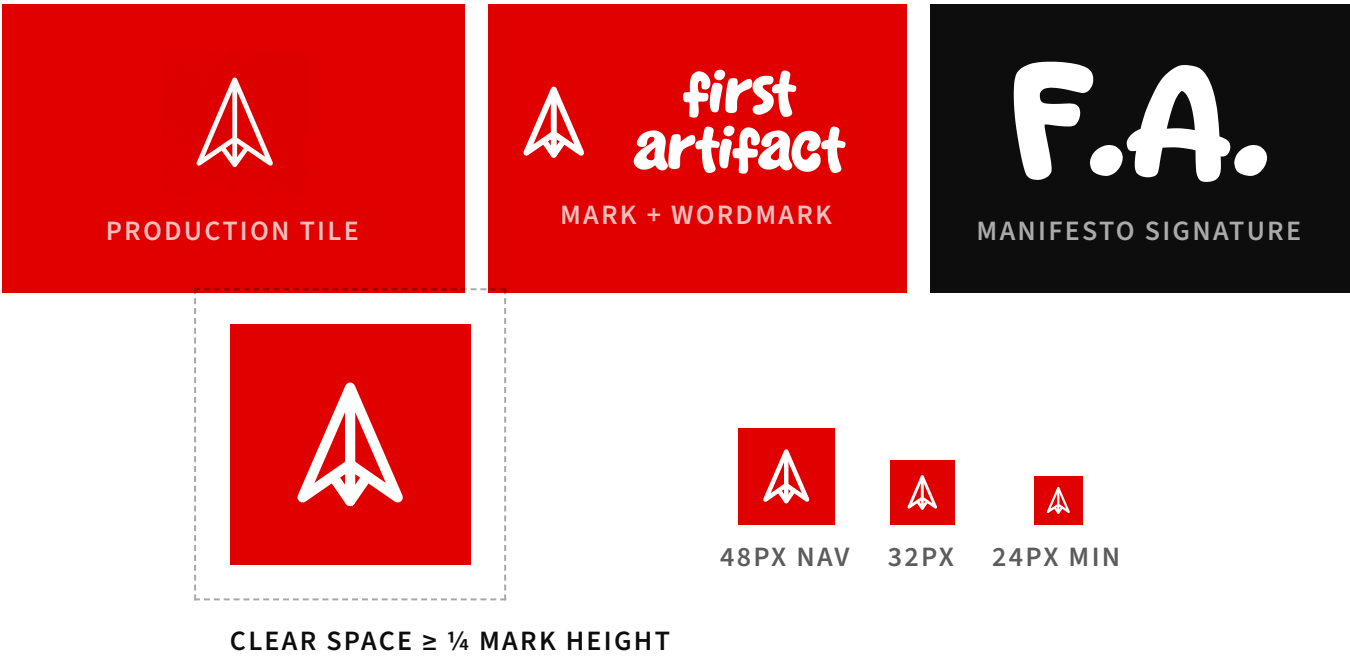
unicorn

ROLE	SIGNATURE LINE
Belief	Obsession beats talent everytime
Proof hinge	and the proof is the artifact.
Hero charge	obsess
Principle stream	obsess · build · ship · prove · agency · evolve · purpose · artifact

ROLE	SIGNATURE LINE
Closing	Your move

the mark

Angular white stroke on a signal-red square — a beacon or first stake. Validate black-and-white first; color second.



ASSET	PATH	ROLE
Production tile	public/brand/first-artifact-logo.png	Favicon, square lockups
Portable vector	public/brand/first-artifact-mark.svg	Export & reuse
Inline UI mark	components/brand-mark.tsx	currentColor + strokeWidth

DO • Keep geometry identical across assets • Use transparent SVG on red chrome • Test silhouette in single color	DON'T • Crop into a circle or recolor casually • Add glow, shadow, or outlines • Redraw or “improve” the paths
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three fields

Signal red is the public beacon. White is the editorial reading surface. Near-black supplies authority. Gray is infrastructure only — never a fourth visual world.

Signal red hsl(0 100% 44%) --signal Header, hero, manifesto, CTA	White hsl(0 0% 100%) Reading fields Marquee interruption	Near-black hsl(0 0% 5%) Primary text, footer Dark actions	
Deep signal hsl(0 91% 37%) Hover / errors	Soft signal hsl(0 100% 96%) Tint only	Muted ink hsl(0 0% 36%) Secondary copy	Border gray hsl(0 0% 82%) 1px structure

transmission fold

HERO	MARQUEE	MANIFESTO	EDITORIAL	CLOSING	FOOTER
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Preserve the hard white interruption between hero and manifesto. Do not soften into gray or glass.
No secondary accent family at launch.

two faces

GoCake is rare and authored — the audible voice. Source Sans 3 is operational and trustworthy. Never set long reading text in GoCake.

GOCAKE REGULAR — DECLARATIONS

obsess · build · ship

Hero charge, marquee, section declarations, F.A. signature. Limited glyph set — fall back for unsupported characters.

SOURCE SANS 3 SEMIBOLD — TITLES & UI

Obsession beats talent everytime

APPLY · STANDARD · HIGH AGENCY

SOURCE SANS 3 REGULAR — BODY

Most rooms reward talk. First Artifact is for founders and builders who move from uncertainty to a shipped thing. Bring the work, the question you cannot drop, and find peers who compound both.

LEVEL	SPEC
Hero charge	GoCake, oversized stack, ~0.85 line-height
Section declaration	GoCake ~51–96px, ~0.88 lh, 10–14 characters/line
Manifesto title	Source Sans Semibold, large belief line
Lead / body	Source Sans Regular 16–20px, relaxed leading
Labels	Source Sans Semibold 12–14px, tracked uppercase

LAWS

- Lowercase Declaration Rule for headings
- Open Title Rule — no trailing period
- Max two families
- Centered type only for manifesto ritual

FILES

public/fonts/gocake/Gocake.ttf

public/fonts/source-sans-3/*.woff2

Keep LICENSE files beside distributed fonts.

What people remember

Build fame and uniqueness. These cues should trigger First Artifact before the name is read.



obsess · build · ship · prove · agency · evolve · purpose · artifact ·
obsess · build · ship · prove · agency · evolve · purpose · artifact ·

ASSET	UNIQUENESS	FAME PLAN
Signal red field	High	Own the red transmission everywhere
Angular mark	High	Never redraw
Lowercase GoCake	High	Keep rare
40px hero grid	Med-High	Hero-only signature
White marquee fold	High	Protect red→white→red
Editorial 1px rows	Medium	Not cards
Circular member signals	Medium	Five-signal constellation

SPATIAL SYSTEM

- Flat planes — depth from fields, rules, type
- Square fields; light 8px on buttons only
- Circles reserved for member/signal markers

NON-ASSETS

- Glassmorphism / backdrop blur
- Purple accents or cream-serif prestige
- Concentric hero rings
- Pill stacks and card dashboards
- Stock “community” photography tropes

- Asymmetric columns over equal card grids
- Solid Surface Rule: no glass, glow, blur

Where it lives

IMAGERY

- Hero character: grayscale, decorative, never a member
- Portraits only with approved name + image + bio
- Manifesto video as atmosphere; copy stands alone
- Never fabricate events, partners, metrics, proof

MOTION

- Sticky side-word convergence
- 18s linear marquee
- Restrained fade-up entries
- Reduced motion → complete static meaning

TOUCHPOINT	IDENTITY EXPRESSION
Launch site /	Full Living Signal system — primary brand theater
Fixed header	Stable signal red, mark + lowercase name, dark Apply
Discord	Same voice; peer room, not funnel gimmick
Application	Six evidence fields; honest unavailable/copy states
Favicon / OG	Red tile mark
Future events	“First Artifact hacker house” descriptors — no new logos
Email / docs	Source Sans body; GoCake sparingly for titles

MONOLITHIC RULE

New surfaces inherit this system. They do not invent sibling brands. Formats stay descriptors under First Artifact.

stay sharp

RECOGNIZE	Living Signal — red field, mark, lowercase charge
BELIEVE	Obsession beats talent; proof is the artifact
QUALIFY	Founders and builders only · High agency · Obsession · Traction
INVITE	Bring the work and the question you cannot drop
ACT	Apply with the work / join the Discord — your move
PROTECT	Smaller exceptional room of founders and builders > large weak membership

validation battery

1. **Swap test** — competitor logo on our layout feels wrong.
2. **Hand test** — cover the mark; red + lowercase + flat editorial still feel like us.
3. **Concept test** — selective · evidence · obsession · living signal.
4. **Field test** — founders/builders feel seen; others feel correctly excluded.

DO

- Keep red → white → red transmission
- Keep headings lowercase and open
- Prefer evidence language and honest unknowns
- Meet WCAG 2.2 AA

DON'T

- Zig into purple, glass, glow, card stacks
- Fabricate social proof
- Set long reading text in GoCake
- Loosen admission copy for growth vanity

DOC

AUTHORITY

BRAND.md

Strategy, voice, logo, distinctive assets

PRODUCT.md

Users, constraints, evidence policy

DESIGN.md

Tokens, components, a11y, motion

DOC	AUTHORITY
asset-manifest.md	Asset provenance & replacement

first artifact

The Living Signal — for founders and builders only.

ONLINESS

The only selective club for founders and builders that admits on shipped proof and sustained obsession.

BELIEF

Obsession beats talent everytime — and the proof is the artifact.

LOOK

Signal red / white / near-black · angular mark · lowercase GoCake + Source Sans 3 · flat editorial · transmission fold.

FEEL

Direct, selective, energetic, honest, playfully strong.

ENEMY

Talk-first rooms. Diluted “anyone in tech” networks.

ASK

Show the work. Apply — or join the Discord. Your move.



BRAND IDENTITY SYSTEM · V1.0